

Efficacy and safety of *Curcuma domestica* extracts in patients with knee osteoarthritis.

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OBJECTIVE: The objective of this study was to determine the efficacy and safety of *Curcuma domestica* extracts in pain reduction and functional improvement in patients with knee osteoarthritis. **STUDY DESIGN AND SETTING:** The design and setting were a randomized controlled study at a university hospital in Bangkok, Thailand. **METHODS:** One-hundred and seven (107) patients with primary knee osteoarthritis (OA) with pain score of $>$ or $=5$ were randomized to receive ibuprofen 800 mg per day or *C. domestica* extracts 2 g per day for 6 weeks. The main outcomes were improvement in pain on level walking, pain on stairs, and functions of knee assessed by time spent during 100-m walk and going up and down a flight of stairs. The adverse events were also recorded. **RESULTS:** Fifty-two (52) and 55 patients were randomized to *C. domestica* extracts and ibuprofen groups, respectively. Baseline characteristics of the patients in both groups were not different. The mean scores of the aforementioned outcomes at weeks 0, 2, 4, and 6 were significantly improved when compared with the baseline values in both groups. There was no difference in those parameters between the patients receiving ibuprofen and *C. domestica* extracts, except pain on stairs ($p = 0.016$). No significant difference of adverse events between both groups was found (33.3% versus 44.2%, $p = 0.36$ in *C. domestica* extracts and ibuprofen groups, respectively). **CONCLUSIONS:** *C. domestica* extracts seem to be similarly efficacious and safe as ibuprofen for the treatment of knee OA.